INDHUMATHI VENKATACHALAM

Senior Product Designer — 0→1, AI/ML & Trustworthy Systems

Seattle, WA · indhumathi.venkatachalam05@gmail.com · indhu.design · linkedin.com/in/indhu05

Summary

Senior product designer, 7+ years, designing the trust layer between people and AI. 0→1: Founding designer — three static screens to 20K+ MAUs and a $1.5M pre-seed. Enterprise ML: 96% weekly active use, scaled from a 43-person pilot to ~4,000 users. Now: Designing an AI-forward marketplace in stealth. Prototypes and ships daily with LLMs and AI agents.

Experience

Independent Product Designer · (Fractional) Remote / Seattle · Jun 2025 – Present

- **Design partner** to an early-stage stealth startup building an AI-forward marketplace — product strategy, 0→1 interface design, AI-agent-assisted prototyping.
- **Ships with LLM and agent tooling** as part of the daily design loop, not an add-on.

Amento · Seattle · Senior Product Designer · Jun 2023 – May 2024

LAT — ML-driven asset lifecycle platform for institutional real estate

- **Led end-to-end design of LAT** across three university campuses, 60–80+ buildings, delivered through a modular API layer over a legacy CMMS/ERP stack. No migration, no workflow disruption.
- **96% weekly active use** among property managers against a 70% leadership benchmark — scaled from a 43-person pilot to ~4,000 users on role-based surfaces (technician, manager, accountant, executive) over one canonical data foundation.
- **Decision time 14 min → 4 min** after reframing predictive alerts from probability scores to cost-consequence framing. Budget revisions fell 36%; per-ticket reporting dropped ~20 → ~8 min.
- **Contained a $180K false-positive alert** in pilot month two, then designed the human-in-the-loop trust architecture — approval gates, confidence tiers, Needs Verification states, override logging feeding model retraining.
- Facilities-team modeling projected that the resulting operating model could reduce unexpected maintenance costs by 25%.

University of Washington, Center for an Informed Public · Misinformation Center · Jan – Dec 2024

Sole designer · Research collaboration with TrueMedia.org

- **~1,800 participants tested live** at Misinfo Day 2024 with UW's Center for an Informed Public unrecruited testing that drove a 3-step Ask Us simplification and skill-progression quiz rewards.
- **Sole designer** of a four-feature consumer media-literacy product: verification search, reverse image search, camera scan-to-verify for print, and human-backed Ask Us built on an agency-over-authority philosophy.
- **A 2,000-respondent survey and 28 interviews** across two phases, plus moderated usability rounds surfaced a generational misinformation chain that defined three archetypes and the product strategy.
- **Research partner TrueMedia.org**, the deepfake-detection nonprofit founded by Oren Etzioni, informed feature prioritization ahead of its 2024 election-cycle launch.

Handel Architects · New York · Product Designer II · Mar 2022 – May 2023

- **+73% engagement** on redesigned search flows; led design of AI-powered property search, virtual tours, and mortgage tools for Hines.
- **2024 Super Bowl:** designed advance wayfinding and digital experiences with NFL stakeholders, focused on crowd flow and fan experience at peak scale.

- **AR/VR condo showings** that extended reach to remote buyers, plus a cross-platform design system that cut design inconsistencies and QA cycles.

Keye · Remote · Founding Product Designer · Jan 2021 – Dec 2022 (Concurrent to Handel)

Credit-based B2C subscription marketplace. The company later joined Y Combinator after this period.

- **0 → 20K+ MAUs in under 12 months**, supporting the company's $1.5M pre-seed raise. As the first and only designer for most of the company's life, took the product from three static screens to a funded marketplace across web, mobile web, and a Chrome extension.
- **+32% trial-to-paid conversion** over the beta cohort. Designed the credit-based access system that became the core business model at $20/month; its behavioral data shaped partnership strategy across a 150+ product catalog, 35+ direct partnerships including Adobe, Grammarly, Otter.ai, +44% YoY partner subscriptions.
- **Chrome extension shipped in 10 days**, solving an 18-month credential-handoff problem: 60% of users installed within three months, login friction fell 63%, repeat sessions rose 41%.
- **Built the design system** from a single parametric product card spanning eight states, three platforms. Hired, mentored, and onboarded the two designers who succeeded me.

Flock.ai · New York · Senior Product Designer · Nov 2021 – Jan 2022 (Concurrent to Keye)

- **Defined early product strategy and designed the MVP:** mockups and prototypes used for user testing and live investor demonstrations during the company's $1M seed raise.

Distribute Aid · Remote · Product Designer · Jun 2020 – Dec 2020

- **Cut task completion time ~60%** on warehouse and shipping workflows for a humanitarian logistics nonprofit; visual-first design improved comprehension for non-native English speakers.

Gensler · Chicago · User Experience Designer · May 2018 – Feb 2020

- **Flagship Bay Area Apple Store** — led UX for the digital experience, delivered on time and within budget.
- **Universal Studios and United Airlines** (Willis Tower amenity hub) — digital transformation experiences integrating sustainability and accessibility requirements.

Education

University of Washington — Graduate Certificate, User-Centered Design · 2024

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee / Southern California Institute of Architecture (SCI-Arc) — Master of Design / Architecture (STEM-designated) · Dec 2017

Skills

AI/ML: Human-in-the-loop systems, responsible AI, confidence and verification states, conversational UI, LLM prototyping and AI agents.

Product design: Product strategy, zero-to-one, interaction design, information architecture, design systems, WCAG 2.2 accessibility

Research: Interviews, surveys, usability testing, synthesis, journey mapping, experimentation

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Storybook, Maze, FullStory, Rive, Lottie, Adobe Creative Suite, Keyshot, ArcGIS, Procreate.

Analytics and collaboration: Google Analytics, stakeholder workshops, design critique, engineering handoff